

Variables in Python

Variables are used to remember pieces of information in a program. They are like boxes where data can be stored and labeled.

Creating a variable

When a number or string is put into a variable it's called assigning a value to the variable. You use an "=" sign to do this. Try this code in the shell window.

Variable name → Value assigned to the variable

```
>>> bones = 3
```

△ Assign a number

To assign a number, type in the variable name, an equals sign, and then the number.

Variable name → String assigned to the variable

```
>>> dogs_name = 'Bruno'
```

△ Assign a string

To assign a string, type in the variable name, an equals sign, and then the string in quote marks.

Printing a variable

The "print" command is used to show something on the screen. It has nothing to do with the printer. You can use it to show the value of a variable.

```
>>> print(bones)
3
```

Variable name →

△ Number output

The variable "bones" contains the number 3, so that's what the shell window prints.

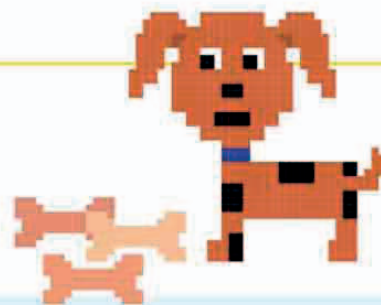
REMEMBER

Variables in Scratch

The command to assign a variable in Python does the same job as this Scratch block. However, in Python you don't have to click a button to create a variable. Python creates the variable as soon as you assign a value to it.

set bones ▼ to 3

Scratch block for giving a value to a variable



```
>>> print(dogs_name)
Bruno
```

No quote marks here →

△ String output

The variable "dogs_name" contains a string, so the string is printed. No quote marks are shown when you print a string.

SEE ALSO

Types of data **110–111** >

Math in **112–113** >
Python

Strings in **114–115** >
Python

Input and **116–117** >
output

Functions **130–131** >